Himaayah Schools
ACADEMY

FREE GUIDE

وَقُل رَّبِّ أَدْخِلْنِي مُدْخَلَ صِدْقٍ

"And say: My Lord, cause me to enter a sound entrance." (al-Isrāʾ 17:80)

Post-UTME and Choosing a Course

The road from the UTME to admission: choosing a course, subject combinations, cut-offs, Post-UTME, JAMB CAPS and the scams to avoid.

بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمٰنِ الرَّحِيمِ

Before you begin

Passing the UTME is only half of getting into university. Admission depends on the course and institution you choose, your O-Level results, your Post-UTME or screening score, and a few rules many candidates only learn when it is too late. This guide explains the whole road, from choosing a course to accepting your admission on JAMB CAPS, with the mistakes our mentors see most often.

Rules change every year

Cut-off marks, Post-UTME formats, fees and dates are set each year by JAMB and by each institution. Always check the current JAMB brochure, your JAMB e-facility profile, and your institution's official website. The figures in this guide are examples to show how things work, not this year's figures.

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Part 1 The road to admission

Step	What happens	What you do
1. Choose	Before UTME registration	Choose your course, institution and the right UTME subjects (Parts 2 and 3).
2. Register	UTME registration with JAMB	Register with your correct details, NIN and subjects. Check everything before you submit.
3. Write the UTME	The CBT exam	Prepare well; your score decides which institutions can consider you.
4. Check your result and the cut-off	After the results	Compare your score with JAMB's minimum and your institution's cut-off for your course.
5. Post-UTME or screening	Set by each institution	Register on the institution's portal; write the test or submit documents for screening.
6. Upload O-Level results	On your JAMB profile	Upload your WAEC or NECO results so the institution can see them.
7. Admission list and CAPS	Institution recommends; JAMB confirms on CAPS	Check CAPS often; accept or reject the offer.
8. Clearance and registration	At the institution	Pay acceptance fees, submit documents and register for courses.

Part 2 Choosing a course

A good choice sits where four things meet: what you **enjoy**, what you are **good at**, what leads to a **career and livelihood**, and what you can realistically **qualify for**.

Question	Why it matters
Which subjects do I enjoy and do well in?	You will study the course for four to six years. Interest keeps you going.
What work do I want to do, and what does it require?	Talk to people in that work. Some careers need professional exams after the degree.
Do I meet the subject and O-Level requirements?	A missing credit in one subject can stop an admission.
How competitive is the course at my chosen institution?	Medicine, law and engineering often have very high cut-offs. Consider a second-choice institution or a related course.
Can I afford it, and where will I live?	Fees, accommodation and transport differ between institutions.
Have I made istikhārah and consulted my parents?	Seek Allah's guidance and the advice of people who know you.

Admission quotas

For federal institutions, admission is commonly shared between **merit**, **catchment area** (states near the institution) and **educationally less developed states (ELDS)**. Choosing an institution in your catchment area, or a less competitive course, can improve your chances.

Part 3 Subject combinations for common courses

Use of English is compulsory for every course. These are the usual three other subjects; some institutions add their own requirements, so **always confirm in the current JAMB brochure**.

Course	Usual UTME subjects (with English)
Medicine and Surgery, Nursing, Pharmacy	Biology, Chemistry, Physics
Engineering	Mathematics, Physics, Chemistry
Computer Science	Mathematics, Physics, and Chemistry or Biology (varies)
Law	Literature in English and two arts or social science subjects (varies by institution)
Accounting, Banking and Finance, Business Administration	Mathematics, Economics, and one other social science subject
Economics	Mathematics, Economics, and one other subject
Mass Communication	Literature in English, and two arts or social science subjects
Political Science, International Relations	Government, and two arts or social science subjects
Islamic Studies, Arabic	Islamic Studies (and Arabic for Arabic), with one or two other arts subjects
Architecture	Mathematics, Physics, and one of Chemistry, Geography, Fine Art, Biology or Economics

Part 4 O-Level requirements

- Most courses require **five credit passes**, including **English Language and Mathematics**, in relevant subjects, in **not more than two sittings**. Some courses accept only one sitting; check.
- WAEC, NECO and NABTEB results are generally accepted. Make sure the subjects match what your course needs: for example, a credit in Biology, Chemistry and Physics for medical courses.
- You may apply with **awaiting results**, but you must upload the results before admission. Do not wait until the last minute.
- Keep your examination numbers, scratch cards or e-PINs safe: you will need them for verification.

Part 5 Cut-off marks and aggregate scores

JAMB sets a **national minimum** UTME score each year for universities, polytechnics and colleges. Each institution then sets its **own cut-off**, which is often much higher for competitive courses. Many institutions combine your UTME score with your Post-UTME score (and sometimes O-Level grades) into an **aggregate**, and admit from the top down.

An example of how an aggregate may be calculated

Suppose an institution gives 50% to the UTME and 50% to its Post-UTME test. A candidate with 280/400 in the UTME and 70/100 in the Post-UTME scores: 280 ÷ 8 = 35, plus 70 ÷ 2 = 35, an aggregate of **70%**.

Institutions use different formulas: some count O-Level grades, some use only the UTME and screening. Find your institution's formula on its official website.

Part 6 Post-UTME and screening

- **Find out the format early:** a CBT test, a written test, or screening of your documents and scores only.
- **Use past questions** from your institution where available; Post-UTME questions usually follow the UTME and O-Level syllabuses in your subjects, sometimes with general knowledge and current affairs.
- **Register only on the official portal** and pay only through the institution's official channels.
- **Prepare the documents:** UTME result slip, O-Level results, birth certificate or age declaration, local government identification, passport photographs.
- **On the day:** arrive early with your documents, and read every instruction.

Part 7 JAMB CAPS, step by step

CAPS (the Central Admissions Processing System) is where your admission is confirmed. Even if your name is on your institution's list, you are not admitted until you accept the offer on CAPS.

1. Log in to your **JAMB e-facility** profile with your email and password.
2. Make sure your **O-Level results** are uploaded and correct.
3. Open **Check Admission Status** and then the **CAPS** page.
4. If an offer appears, read it carefully: institution, course and programme.
5. Click **Accept** if you want it, or **Reject** if you do not. Once you accept, you cannot be offered another admission that year.
6. Print your **JAMB admission letter** when it becomes available, and go to your institution for clearance.

If you are offered a different course from the one you applied for (a change of course on CAPS), think carefully before accepting: it may be a good alternative, or you may prefer to try again next year.

Part 8 Mistakes and scams to avoid

Mistake	Instead
Wrong subject combination for the course	Check the brochure before registering. You cannot be admitted with the wrong subjects.
Choosing only the most competitive course and institution	Choose realistically, and know your options if your first choice does not work out.
Not uploading O-Level results	Upload them on your JAMB profile as soon as they are out.
Paying an “admission agent”	No one can buy you an admission. Agents and “special lists” are scams. Use only official portals.
Ignoring CAPS	Check CAPS regularly, and accept your offer in time.
Wrong name or date of birth on JAMB	Correct any error through JAMB’s official correction service before admission.

Checklist My admission checklist

Done	Step
☐	My course and institution: .....
☐	My UTME subjects match the brochure for this course.
☐	My O-Level results have five credits including English and Mathematics, in the right subjects.
☐	My UTME score: ..... JAMB minimum: ..... Institution cut-off: .....
☐	Registered for Post-UTME or screening on the official portal.
☐	O-Level results uploaded on my JAMB profile.
☐	Checked the admission list and CAPS.
☐	Accepted the offer on CAPS and printed the admission letter.
☐	Clearance documents ready: UTME slip, O-Level results, birth certificate, LGA identification, photographs.

Test Self-test

Choose the best answer. The answers follow the questions.

1. Where is an admission finally confirmed?

a) On social media b) On JAMB CAPS c) By an agent d) At the bank

2. Most courses require O-Level credits in English, Mathematics and three other relevant subjects in:

a) Any number of sittings b) Not more than two sittings c) Five sittings d) One subject only

3. Use of English in the UTME is:

a) Optional b) Only for arts students c) Compulsory for everyone d) Only for Law

4. An institution's cut-off mark is:

a) Always equal to JAMB's minimum b) Set by the institution, often higher for competitive courses c) Fixed by law forever d) The same in every university

5. Someone offers to "buy" you an admission. You should:

a) Pay quickly b) Refuse: it is a scam, and use only official channels c) Pay half d) Ask friends to contribute

6. A candidate scores 240/400 in the UTME and 60/100 in a Post-UTME test, with each counting 50%. The aggregate is:

a) 60% b) 50% c) 45% d) 30%

7. Usual UTME subjects for Engineering (with English) are:

a) Biology, Chemistry, Government b) Mathematics, Physics, Chemistry c) Literature, Government, CRS d) Economics, Commerce, Accounting

8. After accepting an admission on CAPS, you should:

a) Print your admission letter and go for clearance b) Accept another offer c) Do nothing d) Rewrite the UTME

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
1	b) On JAMB CAPS	5	b) Refuse: it is a scam
2	b) Not more than two sittings	6	a) 60%
3	c) Compulsory	7	b) Mathematics, Physics, Chemistry
4	b) Set by the institution	8	a) Print the letter, go for clearance

Question 6: 240 ÷ 8 = 30, and 60 ÷ 2 = 30, so the aggregate is 60%.

Prepare with the Himaayah Academy

Live UTME, Post-UTME and O-Level classes with a personal mentor, daily tasks, weekly mock exams, CBT practice and a leaderboard, all online.

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وَمَا تَوْفِيقِي إِلَّا بِاللَّهِ

"And my success is only through Allah." (Hūd 11:88)

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From your UTME score to your admission letter.

This free guide from the Himaayah Academy explains every step of the admission process in Nigeria, so you choose well and do not miss a deadline.

- Choosing a course that fits you
- UTME subject combinations for common courses
- O-Level requirements, cut-off marks and aggregates
- Post-UTME, screening and JAMB CAPS step by step
- Mistakes and scams to avoid, and a checklist

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